

UNCLASSIFIED

Incident #75

ATIC NO. —

DATE OF INFO

13 Aug 1947

AP NO. —

LOCATION

Twin Falls, Idaho

REPORT NO. —

SOURCE

Male Civilians

DATE OF REPORT —

DATE IN TO ATIC —

TIME OF SIGHTING

1300 MST

COLOR

Sky blue

SHAPE

Inverted Pie Plate

SPEED

1000 mph

SIZE

20' Disk - 10' Thick

ALTITUDE

300' from
observer

COURSE

2700 E to W

LENGTH OF TIME OBSERVED

Momentary

NO. IN GROUP

One

TYPE OF OBSERVATION

Ground

SOUND

Swishing sound

MANEUVERS

Up and down over hills and
hollows of canyon.

PHOTO —

SKETCHES

one

JAN? ATMOSPHERIC EDDY

Temporary ATIC Form 329
(2 Jan 52)

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~~CONFIDENTIAL~~
CHECK-LIST - UNIDENTIFIED FLYING OBJECTS

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Incident # 75

1. Date 13 Aug 47
2. Time 1300
3. Location Snake River Canyon (near Twin Falls) Idaho
4. Name of observer [redacted] and two sons, [redacted]
5. Occupation of observer farmer
6. Address of observer Operator of "[redacted] Farm" [redacted]
7. Place of observation As above - going down the Snake River
8. Number of objects 1
9. Distance of object from observer 300 ft
10. Time in sight momentary
11. Altitude 75 ft from the canyon floor - 300 ft away from observer level view afforded
12. Speed ~~1000 mph~~
13. Direction of flight East to West
14. Tactics Road up and down over hills & hollows of canyon
15. Sound swishing sound.
16. Size 20 feet by 10 ft in thickness
17. Color sky blue
18. Shape oblong broad rimmed hat with low crown
Inverted pie-plate
19. Odor detected None
20. Apparent construction N/S
21. Exhaust trails Exhaust flame - a red tubular fiery glow at the side of the top or hood.
22. Weather conditions N/S
23. Effect on clouds N/S
24. Sketches or photographs one
25. Manner of disappearance disappeared behind hill
26. Remarks: (over)

DOWNGRADED AT 12 YEAR
INTERVALS: 2001 AUTOMATICALLY
DECLASSIFIED 2013 02-04-10

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As the machine went by the [redacted] place, the trees over which it almost directly passed (Mormon Poplars) did not just bend with the wind as if a plane had gone by, but in [redacted] words, "spun around on top as if they were in a vacuum."

[redacted] eight years of age, said he first saw the machine coming down the canyon, heading from east to west and following the contours of the ground. [redacted], age ten, saw it almost immediately. Both watched it fly out of sight behind a tree in a matter of moments. They said they then ran to their Father and learned that he too had seen the machine.

[redacted] seemed completely sincere about the incident. He said his wife and daughter were in the house at the time and had not seen the machine. He questioned his brother, who also lives in the canyon, but his brother had been eating at the time and had seen nothing. [redacted] and his two boys maintained that they had never before seen one of the discs. [redacted] when interviewed, appeared to be a sober, middle-aged man.

[redacted], the "Times News" reporter who originally furnished Special Agents with information about the incident, likewise stated that [redacted] appeared completely sincere about the machine.

No further attempt was made to locate [redacted] inasmuch as [redacted], who was with [redacted] at the time, was interviewed. [redacted] name was withheld from the newspaper because [redacted] and [redacted] were fishing at Salmon dam while [redacted] was supposed to have been working in Twin Falls.

[redacted] said simply that he and [redacted] could hear a roar. They looked up and could see two instruments flying at a great height, which [redacted] mentioned might have been between four thousand and six thousand feet. However, he said he had no idea how large the devices were and consequently, they may have been several miles away. He said that he and [redacted] were satisfied they had seen something and they were very doubtful that they had seen two planes.

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DOWNGRADED AT 12 YEAR
INTERVAL NOT AUTOMATICALLY
DECLASSIFIED. EOD DIR 5200.10

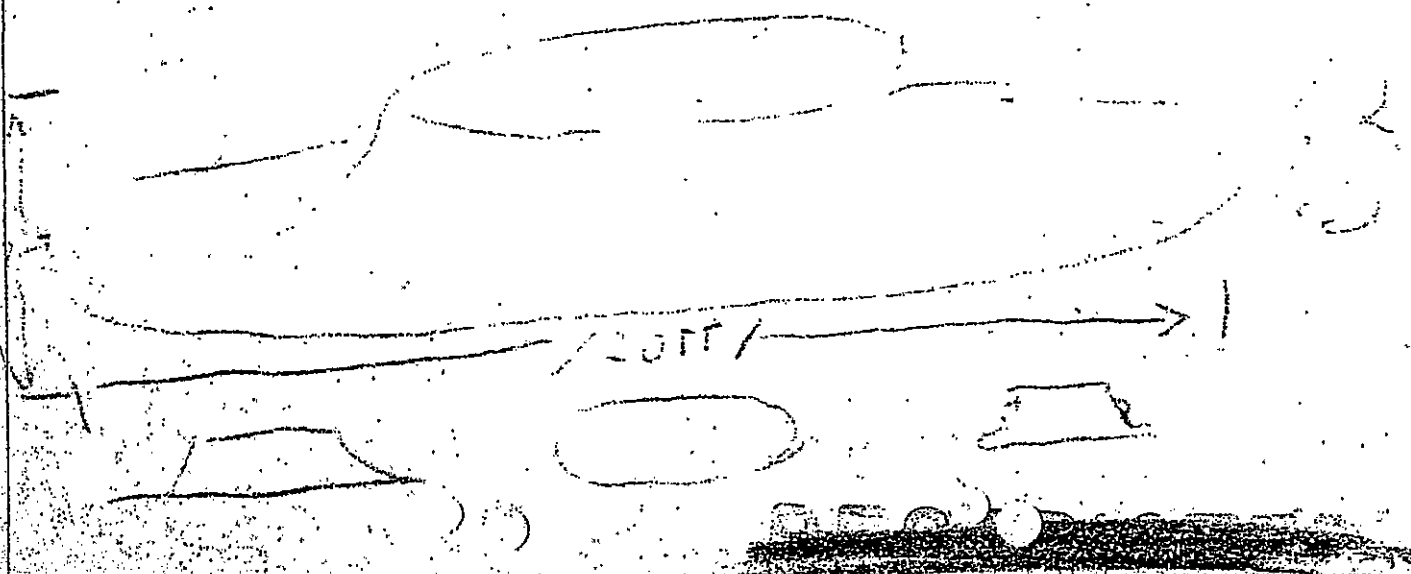
UNCLASSIFIED

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED] had sent his sons to the river for some tops from his boat. As they were overdue he went to look for them, when he noticed some 300 feet away some 75 feet in the air a sky-blue object silhouetted against the steep walls of the canyon on the far side. (The canyon is about 400 ft deep and 1200 ft across at that place.) The object was traveling 75 feet in the air (300 ft below the rim of the canyon) and so was plainly visible. [REDACTED] states that the sky-blue color would probably not be noticed against the sky. He states that "it did not spin like a top". However, he did say that the trees over which it passed almost directly did not just bend with the wind as if a plane had gone by but that they "spun around on-top as if they were in a vacuum."

Keith [REDACTED], a son, eight years of age said he saw the machine coming down the canyon heading from east to west and following the contours of the ground. Billy, age ten, another son, saw it almost immediately. Both watched it fly out of sight behind a tree in a matter of moments.

AGENT'S NOTES: [REDACTED] seemed completely sincere about the incident and appeared to be a sober, middle-aged man. The boys stated that they had never before seen one of the discs.



With 194 incidents thus eliminated, there remain thirty-four which contain some evidence but have no apparent ready explanation. This statement is true only under the assumption that the evidence is accepted as reliable and accurate. When psychological and physiological factors are taken into consideration, all of these incidents can be explained rationally, as pointed out by Rand Corporation and Lt. Fitts of Air Materiel Command Aero-Medical Laboratory (see Appendix "E" and "G").

Air Materiel Command Aero-Medical Laboratory (Dr. Paul M. ...)
212 Incidents considered)

There are sufficient psychological explanations for the reports of unidentified flying objects to provide plausible explanations for reports not otherwise explainable. These errors in identifying real stimuli result chiefly from inability to estimate speed, distance, and size.

All of the remaining 54 incidents are treated in detail in this report. These incidents form no pattern in regard to area of sighting, type of object, or manner of performance. There are indications, however, that some sightings were influenced by earlier reports, and probably would not have been considered unusual or reported had there been no publicity.

APPENDIX I

Project Grudge

Summary of AMC Evaluation of Remaining Reports

VII. Summary of AMC Evaluation of Remaining Reports

The remaining unexplained incidents (see Appendix "I") exhibit a few common characteristics. Two of them, by statements of the reporters, could not have been made had the witnesses not read of the Lt. Rahier Incident (Incident No. 17). Most were distributed without pattern throughout the United States. A few were outside the U. S. No two descriptions of appearance or performance were exactly alike. The reported sightings occurred at various times of day and year.

APPENDIX I

In the following section of this report, each remaining unexplained incident is considered separately. It is not the intent to generally discredit the character of observers, but each case has undesirable elements, and these cannot be disregarded. The numerical designation is merely the categorical order of the incident in the project files.

1, 10, 17, 21, 29, 35, 37, 40, 51, 53, 54, 58, 59, 71, 75, 76, 77, 79, 84,

111, 122, 134, 135, 151, 152, 154, 162, 168, 176, 183, 186, 193, 207, 215, 236.

With all incidents thus eliminated, there remain thirty-four which contain some evidence but have no apparent ready explanation. This statement is true only under the assumption that the evidence is accepted as reliable and accurate. When psychological and physiological factors are taken into consideration, all of these incidents can be explained rationally, as pointed out by Rand Corporation and officials of Air Materiel Command Aero-Medical Laboratory (see Appendix "G").

Air Materiel Command Aero-Medical Laboratory (Dr. Paul M. ...)
242 Incidents considered)

There are sufficient psychological explanations for the reports of unidentified flying objects to provide plausible explanations for reports not otherwise explainable. These errors in identifying real stimuli result chiefly from inability to estimate speed, distance, and color.

All of the remaining 51 incidents are treated in detail in this report. These incidents form no pattern in regard to area or sighting, type of object, or manner of performance. There are indications, however, that some sightings were influenced by earlier reports, and probably would not have been considered unusual or reported had there been no publicity.

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Summary of AIC Evaluation of Remaining Reports

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1, 16, 17, 21, 29, 35, 37, 40, 51, 53, 52, 64, 63, 71, 75, 76, 77, 79, 81,

121, 122, 134, 135, 151, 152, 154, 162, 163, 176, 183, 186, 193, 207, 215, 230,

Incident No. 75 -- 13 August 1947, 1300 hours, Snake River Canyon, Idaho. A farmer together with his two sons, ten and eight years of age, witnessed an object move down a canyon. It was in view only momentarily at a distance of 300 feet, and approximately 75 feet above the ground. The object made a swishing sound, and was sky-blue in color. The farmer doubted the possibility of its visibility if viewed against the sky. The children told of smokeless turbine or exhaust flames shooting from the device through which could be seen daylight. The object passed over some trees, which in the words of the farmer, "spun around on top as if they were in a vacuum."

AMC Opinion: It seems logical to concur with Dr. Hynes's deduction, that this object was simply a rapidly moving atmospheric eddy.

AUG 13, 1947 TWIN FALLS, IDAHO	(KEYHOLE-1950 P 80) 2 WITNESSES	00
OBSERVERS IN A CANYON NEAR TWIN FALLS REPORTED A DISK SHAPED OBJECT. IT		01
APPEARED SKY-BLUE, OR ELSE ITS GLEAMING SURFACE SOMEHOW REFLECTED THE SKY		02
BECAUSE OF THE ANGLE OF VISION. ALTHOUGH IT WAS NOT CLOSE TO THE TREETOPS,		03
THE OBSERVERS WERE AMAZED TO SEE THE TREES WHIP VIOLENTLY WHEN THE DISK RACED		04
OVERHEAD, AS THOUGH THE AIR WAS BOILING FROM THE OBJECT-S SWIFT PASSAGE.		05

[REDACTED]

Incident 775 -- near Twin Falls, Idaho -- 13 August 1947

There is clearly nothing astronomical in this incident. Apparently it must be classed with the other bona fide disc sightings.

Two points stand out, however: the "sky blue" color, and the fact that the trees "spun around on top as if they were in a vacuum." Could this, then, have been a rapidly travelling atmospheric eddy?

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

UNCLASSIFIED

August 20, 1947

65-480

Director FBI

SAC Butte

Flying Discs

C
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Y

Refer teletype to the Bureau dated August 15, 1947

Enclosed please find the newspaper account carried by the Twin Falls, Idaho "Times News" on August 15, together with a sheet of paper on which [redacted] attempted to sketch his impression of the instrument which he claims to have seen.

Concerning [redacted] sketches, it may be noted that he believed the outer edge which he attempted to create in his drawing to have been about a foot through. [redacted] likewise believed that the turbine or exhaust flame which he and his sons claim to have seen was about a foot through and extended at least to the back end of the device. The flame did not appear to taper off nor to widen out toward the back.

[redacted] and [redacted] stated that they could see a knot on the side of the device from which the flames were shooting, and that they could see daylight between the exhaust flame and the side of the device. The flames did not leave any smoke or odor.

The [redacted] boys thought that the "side view" sketch should show that the device was more sharply angled from bottom to top, while [redacted] himself thought that it was more streamlined and curved. [redacted] said that the instrument came to a pointed or rounded top.

In his notations, [redacted] mistakenly said that he had seen it on Thursday. During interview, he stated that it actually had been on Wednesday, August 13, 1947 when he and his sons saw the contrivance about 1:00 P. M.

[redacted] explained that he had sent his boys to the river to get some rope from his boat. When he thought they were overdue, he went outside his tool shed to look for them. He noticed them about 300 feet away looking in the sky and he glanced up to see what he called the "flying discs". He said he could only see it for a moment before it disappeared behind a hill which obscured his view.

[redacted] further stated that the contrivance was about seventy-five feet in the air. [redacted] resides in the depths of the Snake River Canyon, which is about four hundred feet deep and twelve hundred feet across at that place. According to his account, the contrivance was about three hundred feet below the rim of the canyon and he saw it against the steep walls of the canyon on the far side. He described its color as sky blue and stated that he doubted if it could be seen against the sky. He likewise said that it was purely by chance that he saw it. It did not spin like a top.

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Dr. HYNEK'S EVALUATIONS EXTRACTED FROM PROJECT GRUDGE REPORT.

INCIDENT INDEX

1. Astronomical

a. High probability:

#26, 27, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 48, 49, 59, 60, 66, 69, 70, 94,
95, 96, 97, 98, 101, 102, 103, 104, 116, 119, 132, 136, 140,
147, 148, 158, 174, 184, 185, 187, 197, 203, 204, 208, 216,
219, 238.

b. Fair or low probability:

#19, 20, 23, 24, 28, 35, 36, 46, 50, 63, 67, 80, 82, 93, 100,
112, 120, 121, 129, 130, 144, 153, 163, 166, 167, 176, 192,
199, 202, 205, 220, 230, 240.

2. Non-astronomical but suggestive of other explanations

a. Balloons or ordinary aircraft:

#3, 11, 22, 41, 42, 53, 54, 73, 81, 83, 91, 92, 113, 114, 115,
126, 131, 138, 141, 145, 155, 156, 157, 159, 160, 161, 163,
169, 171, 173, 178, 180, 182, 198, 190, 194, 195, 196, 198,
200, 201, 209, 210, 217, 222, 235, 237, 239.

b. Rockets, flares or falling bodies:

#4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 25, 56, 65, 78, 106, 107,
108, 109, 133, 170, 211, 218.

c. Miscellaneous (reflections, auroral streamers, birds, etc.):

#39, 89, 123, 124, 128, 146, 164, 181, 189, 214, 221, 231, 234.

3. Non-astronomical, with no explanation evident

a. Lack of evidence precludes explanation:

#38, 44, 45, 47, 55, 57, 72, 86, 87, 88, 90, 99, 110, 117, 118,
125, 127, 137, 139, 149, 153, 177, 179, 191, 206, 212, 213,
229, 232, 233.

b. Evidence offered suggests no explanation:

#1, 2, 10, 17, 21, 29, 37, 40, 51, 52, 58, 61, 62, 64, 68, 71,
75, 76, 77, 79, 84, 105, 111, 122, 135, 151, 152, 154, 162,
168, 172, 176, 183, 186, 193, 207, 215, 223, 224, 225, 226,
227, 236, 241, 242, 243, 244, 134.

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1994

had made less of a distance from one end of the line than the other, the line would have been pulled out of the ground. Two of the men, one, Zaidi, and Sukkar, had been on the line at the beginning of the trial and saw the line and the hole from the side. Sukkar, who was standing at the end of the line, saw the hole from the south side of the

Saucer Seen Flying Down Snake Gorge

By Frank F. Jones

After seeing the flying saucer north. The boys saw it coming about half a mile up the canyon, and we all lost sight of it in less than a mile."

While the impression was still vivid in their minds, the three got together and made rough sketches of what they had seen. These, in turn, were the basis for the artist's conception of the strange affair by Vic Goertzen of Twin Falls for the Times-News.

"It was all one color—sort of a light sky blue with a red tubular fiery glow at the side of the top or hood," Urie continued.

The canyon floor is rough at that particular point, and it rode up and down over the hills and hollows at a speed indicating some type of control faster than the reflexes of man. It is my opinion that it is guided by instruments and must be powered by atomic energy, as it made very little noise—just a s-s-s-s-s as it passed by.

Urie described the size as about 20 feet long or 10 feet high and 10 feet wide, giving it an oblong shape. It might be described as looking like an inverted pie plate or broad-brimmed straw hat that had been compressed from two sides.

Pressed for his candid opinion of just what it was, Urie said that he was convinced that there was something to this flying saucer situation. "I know a number of the people who have also seen them and I know that they're not just imagining something or trying to get their names in the paper," Urie commented.

"I do know that it scared the boys and made me feel pretty uneasy," he added.

Tracing down a rumor that County Commissioner Hawkins had seen an unusual object in the air on the same day as Urie's experience, the Times-News called him at his Ellers home.

"Yes, I did," he replied without hesitation. "I'll have to admit I've been skeptical all along until I saw it with my own eyes. I can't say what it was, but I can say there's something in the air."

Hawkins related that while at Salmon dam Wednesday morning, a sound resembling the echo of a motor caused him to look upward, and there he saw two circular objects that reflected light. They were traveling at a great speed and

shape. It might be described as looking like an inverted pie plate or broad hammer. Still, that that had been compressed from the sides.

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Hawkins related that while at Salmon dam Wednesday morning, a sound resembling the echo of a motor caused him to look upward, and there he saw two circular objects that reflected light. They were traveling at a great speed and higher than most airplanes according to Hawkins.

Aside from this, he declined to add details, except to say, "There's something in the air."

His general description, however, corresponded closely to those of hundreds of persons who reported seeing flying saucers after Kenneth Arnold, House businessman, had touched off the craze by telling of coming upon nine disc-like objects while he was flying in his private plane in Washington.

Thereafter, the nation became increasingly "flying saucer" conscious, creating a state of mind that made it possible for four "fern and Twin Falls" boys to cause a mild sensation when they built a model flying disc and tossed into a local yard July 10. This was subsequently revealed as a hoax following investigation by the army and FBI.

Thereafter, the "saucer" reports tapered off into a few scattered incidents until the question was revived by this week's occurrences.

Speculation has ranged from mention that the discs could be army or navy guided missile experiments or that they could be similar experiments by some foreign country to "something out of this world."

Whatever they are, a lot of people have seen some thing.